

Competitive analysis — and where the thesis bends

Pressure-tested rather than assumed. One material correction to the strategic frame is carried through everything below.

Correction to the thesis. The frame contrasts our ₹3,000–8,000 incremental spend against a ₹70,000–1,20,000 dedicated stack, giving an 85–95% capex saving. That comparison is against WeP's *large POS terminals* (₹52,990–92,190). But WeP also sells **billing machines from ₹9,990** — BP Joy Pro ₹9,990, BP Joy Plus ₹11,999, BP 2000 ₹13,500 — and that, not an ₹82,790 terminal bundle, is what a single-counter shop is realistically offered. Against the honest denominator the saving is roughly **40–70%**, or ~100% for a shop that already owns a phone and a printer. Still decisive. But an investor who checks — and one will — should find we had already checked.

Matrix

Player	Pricing	HW capex	Voice / AI	Segment	Languages	Offline	Switching cost
Bolo Bill	₹199–299 / ₹1,499–2,999 / ₹7,500+ V	₹0–6,000 (BYOD phone + printer)	Voice-native core — grammar-based, confidence-gated, no LLM in path	Paper-billing single counter → chain	6, code-mixed, data-driven	Not yet built	Low to enter; rises with the shop's own alias catalog
WeP Sol	Hardware sale + software	₹9,990–37,000 billing machines; ₹52,990–92,190 POS terminals	None found	Retail, hardware-led	Limited	Yes (device-local)	High — sunk capex, 300k+ devices installed
Petpooja	₹3,000–12,000/mo reported; some sources ₹1,500–5,000. Not published. +1.5–2% txn fees V	Terminal or BYOD tablet	Add-on at best; 2026 commentary flags it as slow on voice/predictive	Restaurants/QSR, 75,000+	Multi, typed	Partial	High — menu, KDS, aggregator integrations
Vyapar	Free + low-cost paid	₹0 (BYOD)	None — typed entry	Single-store kirana, traders	Local languages, typed	Strong — offline-first	Moderate — ledger and party data
GoFrugal	Mid-market ERP	Terminal-oriented	Rule-based alerts, no voice	Grocery/supermarket, multi-store	Multi	Yes	Very high — ERP + HQ
Zoho	Free to ₹25L rev; ₹999+/mo	₹0	Ecosystem AI, not billing-UX	Accounting-first	Multi	Partial	High — whole-suite gravity
Loyverse	Free; \$29/store/mo paid	₹0 (BYOD)	None	Mobile-first SMB, 1M+ merchants, 170+ countries	Multi	Yes	Low
Square	Free tier; ~2.6%+15¢; \$49–60/mo	\$0 reader → \$799 register	Ecosystem AI	US/global SMB	Multi	Yes	Moderate — payments lock-in

The differentiation window — and why it is a window

The scan supports the central claim: **no scaled player, Indian or global, runs voice as the primary interaction model for billing in 2026**. Where voice appears it is a bolt-on. That is a real opening.

It is not a moat. Three things could close it inside eighteen months:

- **Vyapar adds voice.** They have the offline engine, the languages, the distribution and the ledger data. This is the most likely competitive event and the one to plan against, not hope past.
- **ASR commoditises.** Sarvam, Bhashini and open on-device models are all moving. The capability we buy today will be free tomorrow — good for our cost line, and equally good for everyone else's.
- **An aggregator bundles it.** Petpooja or a quick-commerce platform ships adequate voice to an installed base we would spend years acquiring.

So the defensibility argument cannot be "we have voice". It has to be: **(1)** the per-shop alias catalog, which the shop itself builds and cannot carry to a competitor; **(2)** the corrected-utterance corpus, which is the only realistic route to an on-device model tuned to code-mixed retail speech, and therefore to a cost structure a ₹199/month tier can actually carry; and **(3)** being the one product whose *entire* interaction model assumes the shopkeeper never types — a retrofit competitor bolts voice onto a typed workflow and inherits its assumptions. Points 1 and 2 are the same asset viewed from two directions, and both compound only with real shops. Which makes the pilot, not the technology, the thing worth funding.

Where we lose today — state it first

Against	Their advantage, honestly
Vyapar	Offline. They work with no network; we do not work without one. For a kirana this is not a feature comparison, it is a disqualification. Closing this is non-negotiable before any paid Tier-1 launch.
WeP Sol	A physical thing with a warranty, sold by someone who visits. A ₹9,990 machine that prints is an easier purchase than trusting a phone app — and there is one throat to choke when it breaks.
Petpooja	Depth for F&B — KDS, aggregator integrations, modifiers, table management. We should not chase this; it argues for kirana/provision as the beachhead over cafés, despite the pilot being a café.
GoFrugal / Marg	Everything a chain needs and we have not built. Tier 3 is a roadmap claim, not a product.
All of them	They are proven at scale and we have one design partner. The deck should lead with this rather than be caught by it.

What this implies for positioning

Not "an AI POS". Positioned that way we are compared on feature count against products with a decade of features, and we lose. The defensible position is narrower and truer:

The billing app for the shop that still bills on paper — because it is the only one where nobody has to type, and it speaks the six languages those counters actually run in.

That framing chooses a fight we can win: not against Petpooja's feature depth, but against a notebook and a calculator — where the incumbent has no voice, no languages, no data and no roadmap, and where

88% of Indian retail still lives. It also sets the honest bar for the product: **faster than paper, or it does not ship.**

Bolo Bill · Competitive analysis · WeP and Petpooja pricing spot-checked against public sources, August 2026; Petpooja does not publish rates and reported ranges conflict — treat as a band, not a figure ·  = validate before circulating